

8% ACADEMIC REPORT GUIDELINES

You are required to write an academic report on **one** of the following topics:

1. **What's one thing everyone should know about forests**
 2. **What's one thing everyone should know about trees**
 3. **What's one thing everyone should know about plants**
- OR**
4. **Complete this based on the research initiated in your meeting CA**

- In-Class Assessment		20%	Chair and minutes of a meeting	Chair and write minutes of meeting week 6 (Mon, Oct 6??)
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You will present your findings (from this MS Word-formatted research report) at the end of the semester in class, using a PowerPoint presentation.

REQUIREMENTS

Your academic report, written in Microsoft Word, must meet the following criteria:

- **Length:** 500–750 words
- **Formatting:**
 - Font: Times New Roman
 - Font size: 12 pt
 - Line spacing: 1.5
 - Alignment: Justified
 - Other settings: Default, unless otherwise specified
- **Cover Page:**
 - Include a professionally formatted cover page
 - Delete unnecessary placeholders
 - Replace default image(s) with one suitable for **your** topic
- **Header/Footer:**
 - Insert a header with your **name**
 - Insert a footer with the **page number**
- **Headings and Navigation:**
 - Use appropriate **Heading Styles** throughout the document

Part 1: Write an Academic Report

- Generate an **automated Table of Contents** (likely on page 2, after the Cover Page)
- **Images:**
 - Include relevant and appropriate images
 - Images must be:
 - Properly formatted for repositioning/resizing
 - Accompanied by:
 - A **Caption** (inserted via the *References* tab in Word)
 - A **Harvard citation** within the caption, unless the image is your own
 - Include an **automated Table of Figures**, placed under the Table of Contents
- **Sources:** Your report must reference material from at least:
 - One academic journal (via the SETU Library website)
 - One newspaper article (online or print)
 - One reputable website
- **Reference List:**
 - A **Harvard-style Reference List** must appear on the last page of your report

BEFORE YOU UPLOAD YOUR 8% ACADEMIC RESEARCH DOCUMENT:

1. **Review**
 - Use MS Word's spelling and grammar suggestions
 - Make suitable corrections to improve the quality of your report
2. **Save Your File**
 - Filename should be: **yourname.docx**
3. **Upload**
 - Submit your completed file to the Moodle upload area as instructed

- Presentation

20%

PowerPoint

10% PowerPoint tech skills

10% Communication skills Week 12 (Mon, Dec ???)

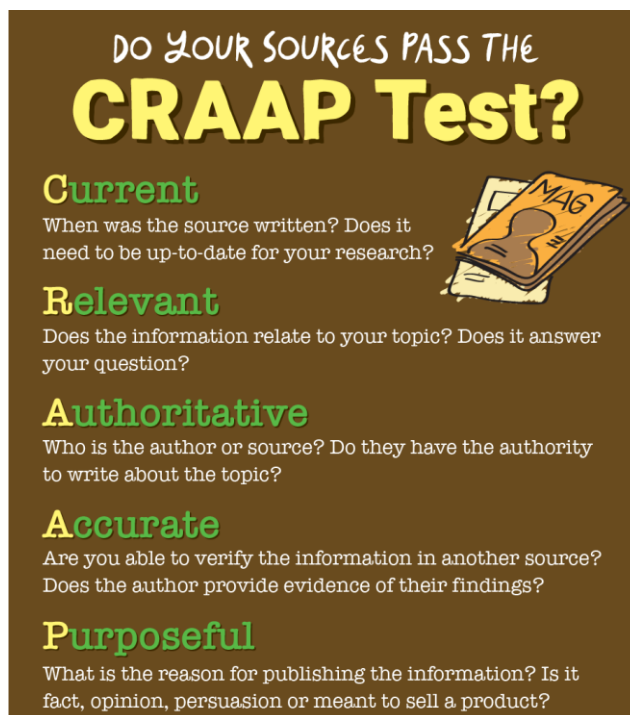
Criterion	CA Weighting	Excellent (80–100%)	Good (65–79%)	Satisfactory (50–64%)	Needs Improvement (<50%)
1. MS Word Formatting & Harvard Referencing	8%	Meets all formatting requirements (font, size, spacing, justified alignment, header/footer, headings, cover page, TOC, TOF, image captions & citations). Harvard referencing is fully accurate and complete.	Minor errors in formatting or referencing; overall well presented and correctly structured.	Several formatting or referencing issues; most required elements present but inconsistently applied.	Poor or missing formatting; referencing incorrect or incomplete; required elements missing.
2. PowerPoint Features (Design, Animation, Timings)	10%	Excellent use of PowerPoint tools (design, layout, animation, transitions, timings); enhances presentation clarity and engagement.	Good use of PowerPoint features; mostly consistent and clear.	Basic use of PowerPoint features; minimal animation or design elements.	Little or no effective use of PowerPoint tools; weak or distracting presentation.
3. Communication Skills (Delivery, Voice, Engagement)	10%	Clear, confident, well-paced delivery; excellent audience engagement; effective use of tone, body language, and eye contact.	Mostly clear and confident delivery; good engagement with minor issues in pacing or delivery.	Understandable delivery but lacks confidence, fluency, or strong audience connection.	Unclear or rushed delivery; little to no engagement; reading directly from slides or notes.

SOURCING INFORMATION

You must use credible sources for all content, including text, images, maps, and statistics.

Credible sources include:

- Scholarly journals
- Conference papers
- Books
- Websites that are reputable and reliable
- And more....



Ask these key questions when evaluating your sources:

- Is there an identifiable **author**?
- Is the **publication date** clear?
- Is there **evidence** to support the claims made?
- Where is the information **published**?
- Where is the **source material** drawn from?

REMINDERS

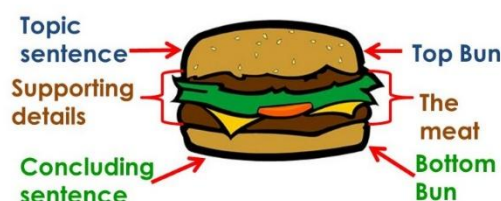
- Ensure your document is **consistent** in style, layout, font, color, and spacing
 - **Proofread** your work for grammar and spelling errors
 - **Re-read** carefully to confirm you have followed all the instructions provided
-

IN SUMMARY: REPORT STRUCTURE

Paragraph Sandwich

Think of a paragraph as a sandwich. It has three parts.

Figure 1: “Meat in the sandwich” Essay Writing Technique



BEGINNING

Remember the title: *What's One Thing Everyone Should Know About...*

Introduction:

- Provide background information on your chosen topic
 - Explain why you chose this topic
 - Briefly outline what the report will discuss
-

MIDDLE

- Use **one paragraph per main point/topic**
 - Include **referenced evidence** to support your discussion
 - Conclude each section by reflecting on:
 - What did you already know?
 - What new knowledge have you gained?
 - Why does this information matter?
-

END

Conclusion:

- Summarise your findings
- Reinforce why the topic matters
- Share what surprised, disappointed, or interested you most
- Discuss future considerations for the topic
- Suggest a **call-to-action** or key takeaway for the reader: the “*Thanks but so what?*”